Close House Race in Washington State Could Matter a Lot

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A tight race for the U.S. **House** is underway in Washington state's 3rd **District**. Cities, factories, farms, and coastal towns are all part of it. Who wins could help decide which party leads the **House**.

Democratic Rep. Marie Gluesenkamp Perez won the seat in 2022. Republican John Braun, a state senator who builds emergency vehicles, wants to take it back. President Trump has won this **district** three times, but voters sometimes split their ballots.

Both candidates talk about **manufacturing**, natural resources, and small businesses. Local people worry about **tariffs** that raise costs, high **house** prices in Vancouver, and hard times for **oyster** farms and fishing towns.

Some Democrats are unhappy with Perez over certain votes. Braun has Trump's support but says he disagrees with very broad **tariffs**. Democrats want Perez to keep the seat. Republicans want Braun to win.

Word Treasure

House -- Short for the U.S. House of Representatives.
district -- An area that elects one member of Congress.
tariffs -- Taxes on goods brought in from other countries.
manufacturing -- Making products in factories.
oyster -- A shellfish that people farm and sell for food.

Background you need

Each U.S. House district elects one member of Congress.

Some districts can vote for different parties for president and for Congress.

Local jobs, prices, and farms often shape what voters care about.

Break it down

WHO: Marie Gluesenkamp Perez and John Braun
WHAT: A competitive race for a U.S. House seat
WHERE: Washington state's 3rd District
WHY: The winner could help decide which party leads the House

Why it matters

House members help make laws about jobs and trade that affect towns where kids live.

Test what you remember

1. Which state has this close House race?

- (A) Washington
- (B) Alaska
- (C) Hawaii
- (D) Florida

2. Who is the Democrat in the race?

- (A) John Braun
- (B) Kathleen Nisbet
- (C) Marie Gluesenkamp Perez
- (D) Erik Halvorson

3. What does John Braun's company build?

- (A) Ice cream trucks for space
- (B) Emergency vehicles
- (C) Toys only
- (D) Violins

4. What problem do oyster farms face in the story?

- (A) Too much free ice
- (B) Too many tourists forever
- (C) No ocean nearby
- (D) Lost international sales amid trade tensions

5. Why do parties care about this seat?

- (A) It chooses weather
- (B) It could help decide who controls the House
- (C) It sets school lunch menus only
- (D) It picks the next king

6. What does the mayor say voters sometimes do?

- (A) Mail socks instead of ballots
- (B) Vote only on Mondays
- (C) Skip voting forever
- (D) Split tickets between parties

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: B 4: D 5: B 6: D

Questions to think about

1. John Braun: Says candidates must earn votes and criticizes very broad tariffs.
2. Erik Halvorson: Says voters split tickets and want authentic leaders.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):